

BRANDSTRO

YOUR ROLE: R&D

Personal Operating Brief | Reports to: Creative Team Head | Version 1.0 | Full SOP: Section 6.5 / 12

"Every logo and packaging project in Brandstro starts with you. You're one person doing research for the whole company — which makes your output the most important single input in the entire production line, and your time the most protected resource in the business."

You are a capacity bottleneck by design, not by accident. Every project depends on your brief before it can move. Working ahead when you have slack, and flagging overload early, matters more for you than for almost anyone else at Brandstro.

WHAT YOU OWN

- Industry, competitor, and category research
- Target audience and brand positioning research
- Visual, symbol, and cultural reference research
- Producing a **structured** research brief — not raw inspiration links
- Handing off direction to the Sketch Artist (logo) or Packaging Team (packaging)
- Working ahead on queued projects when today's capacity allows

YOUR RESEARCH BRIEF TEMPLATE — EVERY PROJECT, EVERY TIME

- ☐ Client & business overview
- ☐ Target audience
- ☐ Competitor / category references (3–5 examples)
- ☐ Positioning direction (1–2 sentence recommendation)
- ☐ Visual/symbol direction (mood, motifs, cultural references if relevant)
- ☐ Anything the client explicitly wants included or avoided

A structured brief that hits every box above is worth more to the Sketch Artist and Logo Team than a longer but scattered one. Consistency is what makes downstream teams fast.

YOUR QUEUE & PRIORITY SYSTEM

Priority	Rule
P1 — Urgent	Founder/Creative Team Head approved urgent project. Jumps the queue. Only one P1 active at a time.
P2 — Standard	Normal paid project, worked in the order payment was confirmed (FIFO).
P3 — Ahead	Upcoming project you can work on while waiting on a dependency elsewhere. Only fill in when no P1/ P2 is ready.

YOUR RHYTHM

Daily	Work the queue in priority order. Produce one structured brief per project using the template. Log the handoff in the Project Tracker the moment it's done.
Weekly	Report your queue length and flag any at-risk project to Creative Team Head — before it becomes a missed deadline, not after.

HANDOFF — HOW A PROJECT LEAVES YOUR DESK

- 1 Mark the brief complete in the Project Tracker
- 2 Tag the next owner: Sketch Artist (logo projects) or Packaging Team (packaging projects)
- 3 Save the brief itself in the project's Drive folder — **02_R&D**
- 4 An unacknowledged handoff is treated as not yet started — confirm the next owner has picked it up

YOUR THROUGHPUT BENCHMARK

Function	Headcount	Approx. Daily Throughput
R&D (you)	1	≈ 2 project briefs/day

This benchmark gets re-validated in the monthly review, not assumed permanent — if it's consistently wrong in either direction, say so.

WHAT YOU DECIDE VS. WHAT YOU ESCALATE

Decision	You
Resequence same-priority projects for your own efficiency	✓ Decide
Depth and direction of your own research approach	✓ Decide
Deprioritize a Founder/CRM-flagged urgent project	↑ Needs Creative Team Head approval
Your queue is consistently overloaded	↑ Flag to Creative Team Head — don't just work longer hours silently

ESCALATION — YOUR POSITION

Situation	What You Do
Requirement/brief from CRM is unclear	Flag back to CRM before researching on an assumption
Queue backing up beyond a day or two	Report to Creative Team Head in the weekly (or sooner if urgent)
A P1 urgent project lands on your desk	Drop to it immediately; everything else queues behind it

HOW YOU'RE MEASURED

Metric	Measured Via	Reviewed
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Briefs delivered on time	Project Tracker	Weekly
Briefs requiring rework	Team Leader feedback	Weekly

DAY 1 — WHAT YOU PERSONALLY DO

- ☐ Get access to the Project Tracker and the Drive project folders
- ☐ Pull today's queue in payment-confirmed order and identify anything already at risk
- ☐ Start using the structured research brief template from your very next project
- ☐ Flag your realistic daily brief capacity to Creative Team Head so the queue reflects reality

Brandstro Internal Operating System — Phase 1 · Individual Role Brief for R&D · Full detail in the master SOP, Sections 6.5, 7, 12, 28–29,